

Indian language content is the only solution to this. Although funds have been earmarked for this, they have so far been spent in the wrong manner.

Which brings us to the question, “Who is paying for this?” In India, the poor pay more taxes than the rich. While direct taxes in India are progressive, the indirect taxes are still regressive.

In convergence, culture and language need to be bound very closely. Nuances of language, which may say more than anything else, are better in one’s own language than in any other.

India is a diverse country and that is its richness. By trying to do everything in English, we might just kill our own character.

Our language shapes our habit of thought. Different languages shape different thoughts. We need all these languages to thrive if we want different, rich thoughts to be thought out. Information and Communication Technology (ICT) can enable this. But for that, we need people who are passionate about diversity.

There are different groups of people with different needs. Those for whom convergence must happen need unique solutions. A VCD player and a black-and-white TV that costs Rs 3,000 can help communities access information that was hitherto beyond their reach. This is convergence.

Convergence solutions need to be robust and cheap, not necessarily interactive. One-way

communication with a time lag is fine—so long as it happens.

Thinking that we need continuous interaction could make people miss out. The Internet is not available in our languages, and depriving people of information till that happens could leave people out in the cold. Providing solutions in ten days is also fine so long as there is an assurance that it will happen.

Innovation, as I said earlier, is the way ahead. Innovation will come through diversity—the very character of India.

Convergence can be a shortcut to diversity. It should not lead to congruence to identical things. Imagine, then, innovation that has come about thanks to convergence, converted into enterprise. A grassroots revolution can trigger globalisation. Sharing these innovations is the way to move ahead and the way to true convergence. Yes, you could charge a licence fee and patents could be granted... but this is the way ahead. ■

Dr Anil K Gupta is a professor at the Centre for Management in Agriculture at IIM-Ahmedabad; co-ordinator of SRISTI (Society for Research and Initiatives for Sustainable Technologies and Institutions; www.sristi.org) and of the Honey Bee Network; and Executive Vice Chair of the National Innovation Foundation. Honey Bee is a newsletter on indigenous innovations (www.sristi.org/honeybee.html).

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